

Checklist:

Managing Yourself Checklist

Know yourself

- ☐ Identify my top strengths
- ☐ Identify my biggest weaknesses
- ☐ Write down 3 words people close to me would use to describe me
- ☐ List 3 qualities I am most proud of
- ☐ Name traits that helped me succeed in the past
- ☐ List the most common positive feedback I receive
- ☐ Notice my inner-critic patterns
- ☐ Identify situations that trigger self-doubt or overreaction
- ☐ Write down common feedback on how I could be more effective

Calibrate with reality

- ☐ Ask my manager where they see my biggest opportunities for growth
- ☐ Ask my manager what is holding me back from greater impact
- ☐ Ask how my skills compare with the ideal person in my role
- ☐ Ask 3–7 trusted coworkers for honest feedback
- ☐ Request specific, actionable feedback rather than general praise
- ☐ Ask for task-specific feedback after presentations, meetings, or projects
- ☐ Thank people for feedback without getting defensive

Shift out of imposter syndrome

- ☐ Notice when I am telling myself a worst-case story
- ☐ Pause and ask: “What evidence do I actually have?”
- ☐ Consider alternative explanations before assuming the worst
- ☐ Replace fixed-mindset thoughts with growth-mindset thoughts
- ☐ Treat discomfort as part of learning, not proof I am failing
- ☐ Remind myself that early confusion in management is normal

Understand my best conditions

- ☐ Identify the conditions in which I do my best work
- ☐ Notice what gives me energy and momentum
- ☐ Protect time for thinking and reflection
- ☐ Get enough sleep
- ☐ Create routines that support focus and recovery
- ☐ Structure my calendar in a way that helps me work well

Understand my triggers

- ☐ Notice which people or situations reliably set me off
- ☐ Separate normal frustration from strong emotional triggers
- ☐ Reflect on moments when I overreacted
- ☐ Identify recurring pet peeves and why they affect me
- ☐ Pause before responding when triggered
- ☐ Cool down before making decisions or replying

Build confidence when I'm struggling

- ☐ Stop punishing myself for feeling bad
- ☐ Name the worry directly instead of letting it swirl
- ☐ Question whether my interpretation is accurate
- ☐ Visualize handling hard situations successfully
- ☐ Remember the previous challenges I have handled well
- ☐ Ask trusted people for help when I am in a rut
- ☐ Keep a record of small wins
- ☐ Celebrate progress, not just big outcomes

Protect my wellbeing

- ☐ Set boundaries around work time
- ☐ Schedule short non-work breaks into my day
- ☐ Make time for exercise, hobbies, or rest
- ☐ Preserve time with family and friends
- ☐ Avoid letting work consume all mental space

Learn faster as a manager

- ☐ Ask for feedback often
- ☐ Use my manager as a coach, not just an evaluator
- ☐ Bring hard problems to my manager early

- ☐ Treat 1:1s as learning time
- ☐ Learn from peers and informal mentors
- ☐ Ask skilled coworkers how they do what they do
- ☐ Set aside regular time to reflect on what I learned
- ☐ Review my week and write down key takeaways
- ☐ Set goals for the next 6 months
- ☐ Revisit goals and evaluate what worked
- ☐ Take advantage of formal training when useful

Keep perspective

- ☐ Focus on becoming better, not perfect
- ☐ Play to my strengths instead of copying someone else's style
- ☐ Remember that good management is personal
- ☐ Stay true to my values while improving my skills